

Cracking India's toughest appliance market

The Indian AC market is brutal, but Acerpure's Vasudeva G has a plan

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Acerpure, Acer's consumer appliance sub-brand, launched seven new split inverter AC models this summer under the Chill Neo series, priced from Rs 29,990 to Rs 54,990 across 1-ton, 1.5-ton and 2-ton capacities. It is, by any measure, a serious entry into a market that Voltas, LG, and Daikin have treated as their collective inheritance for decades. We recently sat down with Vasudeva G, Director of Acerpure India, to understand how the company plans to carve out a space for its newly launched Acerpure Chill Neo series in a sector where consumer loyalty is hard-won.

"On the market share, I don't think that's something that we are really focused on," Vasudeva said. "We are right now looking at how we establish ourselves as a brand and then slowly move into the next phase of this growth when we start really looking at the scale." What he did point to was traction on e-commerce platforms including Flipkart and Amazon where

Acerpure is already being recognized as a consideration brand and a more grounded near-term target of 2% to 3% online market share, a number he drew from the TV business as a reference point.

"When we talk about Acer coming with a product," he says, "partners and consumers actually look forward to what technology Acer can bring."

Whether that expectation is easily fulfilled is another matter. What Acerpure has actually delivered in the Chill Neo series is use of 100% copper coils, compliance with the new 2026 BEE star rating norms, a 7-in-1 convertible cooling mode that adjusts output across seven occupancy levels and a claimed operational ceiling of 58°C ambient temperature. Vasudeva believes all of that bodes well for the brand.

Vasudeva also told me about an Ice Blast mode on Acerpure's Chill Neo series of ACs which he promises

isn't a gimmick and is designed for the moment you walk into a room that has been baking since noon. It runs the compressor hard and fast to bring the room down quickly, then backs off.

The launch itself was delayed by nearly six months. "We kind of delayed our launch because we wanted to offer a sustainable product," he explained. "This is the reason why our launch is delayed for almost 6 months, otherwise we would have probably launched in 2025." The new ISEER rating norms kicked in January 2026 and Acerpure chose to have a longer runway by waiting.

The manufacturing is handled by PG Electroplast, a contract manufacturer that already serves several established appliance brands and has, by Vasudeva's account, been evaluated specifically on the degree of component localization it can offer.

Acer's existing 8 million customer base converts into appliance purchases faster than a cold market entry would allow. The brand has already tasted success with its TV numbers, whether the same logic holds for ACs, which require installation, after-sales service, and a longer ownership relationship than a television, is still to be demonstrated. The precedent is hard to ignore, but cooling is a different contract with the consumer.

Asked what Acerpure should mean in the Indian consumer's mind five years from now, Vasudeva said, "Intuitive design and trusted service, value for money, convenience and connectedness. This is how we want customers to remember Acerpure."

The ambition is obvious. Yet, it is too early to put a finger on exactly where Acerpure will rank in such a fiercely segmented market. **d**



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